

THE CHINESE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG, SHENZHEN

Teaching Innovation Grant Scheme

The Teaching Innovation Grant (TIG) Scheme of CUHK(SZ) provides funding for academic staff to investigate, develop and implement innovative initiatives that enhance teaching and learning (T&L) outcomes. It aims to nurture a research-based teaching culture, and most importantly, enhance students' learning experiences and educational outcomes.

1. Objectives

- (i) To address particular T&L issues and explore innovative means to overcome the problems and bring about substantial changes in T&L;
- (ii) To support the development of signature courses that set a benchmark for T&L quality;
- (iii) To encourage teachers, especially young ones, to conduct pedagogical research; *and*
- (iv) To serve as seed money for projects that can go on to apply for external education grants and awards.

2. Eligibility

- (i) Full-time academic staff ranked Lecturer or above are eligible to apply as individuals or as groups. The Principal Investigator (PI) should have at least one year of teaching experience at CUHK(SZ). Groups may include academic staff from other institutions.
- (ii) Each PI is allowed to submit one application, and each applicant can participate in a maximum of two TIG supported projects at any time.
- (iii) If the evaluation of the previous TIG project is deemed *unsatisfactory*, the applicant will be ineligible to apply for two years.

3. Application Procedures

The project proposal, together with an Application Form (*Attachment I*), should be endorsed by the School Dean before being submitted to CLEAR. The Committee on Teaching Innovation and Achievements (TIA Committee) shall shortlist the proposals, and may request a presentation or additional supporting materials during the selection process.

The applications should include clear and detailed descriptions of 1) The background of proposed innovation, 2) A clearly defined problem in T&L, 3) A feasible implementation plan with a clear timeline to solve the problem, 4) An assessment plan to measure student learning outcomes, 5) Expected outcomes, deliverables, and a dissemination plan for sharing the research experience, *and* 6) The project budget plan.

4. Selection Criteria

The proposals will be assessed based on the following criteria:

- (i) A clearly defined problem and its significance in T&L;
- (ii) Clear project outcomes and deliverables;
- (iii) The innovative ideas likely applicable to multiple courses, replicability, and sustainability;
- (iv) An explicit evaluation plan for project;
- (v) Cost-effectiveness with reasonable and feasible budget details;
- (vi) Potential to develop into a signature course; *and*
- (vii) Potential to gain external teaching project or teaching award.

5. Budget

Every proposal should include a detailed budget, ranging from RMB 10,000 to 80,000. The expenditure of the TIG funds shall strictly follow the Policy on the Use of Teaching Innovation Grant Fund (*Attachment II*) and the University financial regulations.

6. Project Duration

The funding period is two years. In special cases, the PI can apply for up to six-month extension in the project Application Form for Amendment with detailed justifications and seek CLEAR's approval at least one month before the original completion date. Failure to obtain prior approval may lead to project termination.

7. Project Evaluation

Each team shall submit a progress report after one year, and a final report within one month of project completion. The TIA Committee will evaluate projects against their objectives, outcomes, and results, using three performance levels: "Very Satisfactory" "Satisfactory" and "Unsatisfactory." Project teams are also required to present their work at sharing events organised by CLEAR or relevant Schools.

8. Project Amendments

Any major changes to the approved projects, including but not limited to change of PI, deferral of completion date, or termination of project, require the submission of an Application Form. The PI is strongly advised to report any major changes to and seek endorsement of CLEAR in advance, to ensure timely and proper handling of the amendments.

9. Acknowledgement

All publications resulting from the funded project must acknowledge the financial support provided by TIG. The recommended acknowledgement format is: "*This project was supported by the Teaching Innovation Grant (Project No. xxxxxx) of The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen.*"



10. Intellectual Property Rights

The University holds the copyright to all courseware, software, and teaching materials developed through TIG-funded projects.

11. Stewardship

The Committee on Teaching and Learning (CTL) shall oversee the TIG Scheme. The TIA Committee, designated by CTL, will review and select the TIG proposals, and evaluate the completed projects. CLEAR is responsible for administering the TIG Scheme.

CLEAR

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